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Computing • IT • Business

HARVARD REFERENCING HANDBOOK



INCLUDES INTRUCTION ON THE USE OF GENERATIVE AI TOOLS

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What is Harvard referencing?

Harvard referencing is a citation style used in academic writing and research to acknowledge the sources of information and ideas. It is widely used in various disciplines, including the social sciences, humanities, and natural sciences.
The Harvard referencing system requires you to provide brief details about the source directly in the text of your work, and a full reference list at the end.

Why is it important to reference your sources?

In the realm of academic writing, proper referencing plays a pivotal role in upholding the standards of integrity, credibility, and intellectual engagement. As we delve into the key aspects of referencing, particularly in the context of avoiding plagiarism and maintaining academic standards, it becomes evident that this practice extends far beyond a mere technicality. Let's explore the fundamental reasons why referencing is an indispensable skill for any scholar or researcher.

Avoids Plagiarism:
Proper referencing serves as a robust shield against unintentional plagiarism, safeguarding the integrity of your work. By crediting the original authors or creators of ideas, words, or works, it ensures a clear demarcation between your thoughts and those of others.

Fosters Academic Integrity:
Referencing goes hand in hand with academic integrity, serving as a tangible demonstration of honesty in scholarly pursuits. This ethical foundation is crucial for maintaining the credibility of academic work and fostering a culture of trust within the academic community.

Lends Credibility to your Argument:
In the academic landscape, credibility is paramount. Referencing not only adds weight and authority to your work but also signifies a commitment to thorough research and grounding in existing knowledge. Furthermore, it provides readers with the means to verify and trace the sources used, enhancing the overall reliability of your scholarly contribution.

Facilitates Further Research:
Beyond its immediate benefits, referencing plays a crucial role in facilitating further research. By providing a transparent trail of consulted sources, it encourages readers to explore and expand upon existing knowledge. This, in turn, contributes to the ongoing scholarly conversation and the overall advancement of the field.

Demonstrates Research Skills:
Referencing is not just a technical requirement; it is a tangible showcase of your research skills. Your ability to locate, evaluate, and seamlessly integrate relevant sources into your

work reflects a depth of engagement with the subject matter that extends beyond the surface.

Allows for Critical Evaluation:

Moreover, referencing encourages a culture of critical evaluation. It prompts both the writer and the reader to assess the quality and reliability of information presented. This skill is vital in differentiating between authoritative and questionable sources, fostering a discerning approach to academic inquiry.

Complies with Academic Standards:

Adherence to citation and referencing standards is not just a formality but a necessary practice for ensuring compliance with academic regulations. Straying from these standards may result in penalties, underlining the significance of meticulous referencing in academic work.

Allows Accurate Attribution and Shows Respect for Intellectual Property:

Finally, referencing ensures accurate attribution of ideas, data, and quotations to their original sources. This not only aids in avoiding misrepresentation but also upholds the principles of respecting intellectual property rights. By acknowledging the contributions of others, referencing supports a culture of fairness and respect within the academic community.

How to reference resources in the Harvard format

The Harvard referencing style, a widely used citation method, consists of two essential elements:

1. In-Text Citation:

The in-text citation is an integral part of the main text where the work of others is referenced.

Typically, it follows the format: (Author, Year of Publication, Page Number).

This citation is placed within parentheses, either at the end of a sentence or integrated into the text, allowing readers to quickly identify the source of the information.

> Example:
> According to Smith (2010, p.25), proper referencing is crucial for academic integrity
> OR
> Proper referencing is crucial for academic integrity (Smith, 2010, p.25)

2. Reference List:

The reference list is a comprehensive compilation of all the sources used in the assignment.

This list is arranged alphabetically by the author's last name, and it should be positioned at the end of your assignment.
Each entry in the reference list provides detailed information about the source, including the author's name, publication year, title, and other relevant details.

Example:

Smith, J. (2010) The Art of Referencing. London: Academic Press.

Including both in-text citations and a reference list is crucial for academic writing.
The in-text citations guide readers to the specific sources within the text, while the reference list offers a comprehensive overview of all sources used in the assignment.

Books

Print Books

Pattern:
Author Last Name, Author First/Middle Name Initial(s). (Publication Year). *Title of the Book*, Publisher Location: Publisher Name.

Book with One Author

In text Citation: Montgomery (2013, p.57) states that...
Reference List: Montgomery, C.A. (2013) The strategist: be the leader your business needs. London: HarperCollins.

Book with Two or Three Authors

In Text Citation: According to Goffin and Mitchell (2010, p.43)...
Reference List: Goffin, K. and Mitchell, R. (2010) Innovation management: strategy and implementation using the pentathlon framework. 2nd ed.Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan.

Books with Four or more Authors

In Text Citation: Young et al. (2015) proved that...

Note: et al. means 'and others'

Reference List: Young, H.D. et al. (2015) Sears and Zemansky's university physics. San Francisco, California: Addison- Wesley

Edited Book with One Editor

In Text Citation: Prest (2014,p.22)discusses...
Reference List: Prest, W. (ed.) (2014) The professions in early modern England. London: Croom Helm.

Note: 'ed.' is used to indicate a single editor.

Edited Book with Two to Three Editors

In Text Citation: Wardrip-Fruin and Montfort (2003, p.46) argue that...
Reference List: Wardrip-Fruin, N. and Montfort, N. (eds.). (2003) The new media reader. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press.

Note: 'eds.' is used for multiple editors.

Edited Book with more than Four Authors

In Text Citation: Bocken et al. (2019, p.62) support the theory that...

Note: et al. means 'and others'

Reference List: Bocken, N. et al. (eds.) (2019) Innovation for sustainability. New York, NY: Springer Berlin Heidelberg.

Note: 'eds.' is used for multiple editors.

Book with no Author

In Text Citation: The Percy tomb has been identified as 'one of the masterpieces of Medieval European art'. (Treasures of Britain and treasures of Ireland,1990,p.84)
Reference List: Treasures of Britain and treasures of Ireland (1990) London: Reader's Digest Association Ltd
Note: If no author is listed, you should use the title of the book instead.

eBooks

Pattern:

Author Last Name, Author First/Middle Name Initial(s). (Publication Year) *Title of the E-Book*, Publisher Location: Publisher Name. Available at: URL (Accessed: Access Date).

OR

Author Last Name, Author First/Middle Name Initial(s). (Publication Year) *Title of the E-Book*, Publisher Location: Publisher Name. DOI

eBook from a Subscribed Database

In Text Citation: Fabozzi and Peterson Drake (2009, p.67) argue that...
Reference List: Frank J. Fabozzi and Pamela Peterson Drake (2009) Finance: Capital Markets, Financial Management, and Investment Management. Hoboken, N.J.: Wiley Available at: https://search.ebscohost.com/login.aspx?direct=true&db=e020mww&AN=274974&site=eds-live (Accessed: 18 November 2021).

OR

Frank J. Fabozzi and Pamela Peterson Drake (2009) Finance : Capital Markets, Financial Management, and Investment Management. Hoboken, N.J.: Wiley.DOI:10.1002/9781118266984.

Note: When accessing database materials, please refrain from using the session link. Instead, utilize the permalink provided by EBSCO through the 'Cite 'function. This permalink ensures a stable and permanent link to the resource. Alternatively, you may opt for the DOI (Digital Object Identifier), if available. You can search for the DOI of a resource on Google.

eBook from an Open Access Source

In Text Citation: Sekerkaya (2020) states that...
Reference List: Sekerkaya, A.K. (ed.) (2020) Contemporary Issues in Strategic Marketing. Istanbul University Press. Available at: https://iupress.istanbul.edu.tr/en/book/contemporary-issues-in-strategic-marketing/home

OR

Sekerkaya, A.K. (ed.) (2020) Contemporary Issues in Strategic Marketing. Istanbul University Press. Available at: https://doi.org/10.26650/B/SS05.2020.002.

Journal Articles

Print Journals

Pattern:

Author Last Name, Author First/Middle Name Initial(s). (Publication Year) 'Title of the article', Name of the Journal, Volume Number, (Issue Number), pp.

In Text Citation: Giboney, Briggs and Nunamaker (2019, p.65) believe that...
Reference List: Giboney, J. S., Briggs, R. and Nunamaker, J. (2019) 'Special Section: Engineering Artifacts and Processes of Information Systems', Journal of Management Information Systems, 36(1), pp. 11–13.

e-Journals

Pattern:

Author Last Name, Author First/Middle Name Initial(s). (Publication Year) 'Title of the article', Name of the Journal, Volume Number, (Issue Number), pp. (Page number starts-ends). Digital Object Identifier or Available at: URL (Accessed: Access Date).

In Text Citation: According to Korte (2021), e-Commerce...
Reference List: Korte, A., Tiberius, V. and Brem, A. (2021) 'Internet of Things (IoT) Technology Research in Business and Management Literature: Results from a Co-Citation Analysis', Journal of Theoretical & Applied Electronic Commerce Research, 16(6), pp. Available at: https://www.mdpi.com/0718-1876/16/6/116

OR

Korte, A., Tiberius, V. and Brem, A. (2021) 'Internet of Things (IoT) Technology Research in Business and Management Literature: Results from a Co-Citation Analysis', Journal of Theoretical & Applied Electronic Commerce Research, 16(6), pp. 2073–2090. doi: 10.3390/jtaer16060116.

Webpages

Pattern:
Organization Name or Author Last Name, Author First/Middle Name Initial(s), (Publication Year, if there is no date, use n.d.) Name of the Website. Available at: URL (Accessed: Access Date).

Webpage with One Author

In Text Citation: In his article, Michael Fox (2021) discusses...
Reference List: Fox, M(2021) Bitcoin's failed breakout means it could fall an additional 12% if it drops below key $58,000 support level, technical analyst says. Available at: https://markets.businessinsider.com/news/currencies/bitcoin-price-technical-outlook-btc-58000-support- crypto-katie-stockton-2021-11(Accessed: 18 November 2021).

Webpage with an Organization as Author

In Text Citation: As per Google's terms of service (Google, 2021)...
Reference List: Google (2021) Google terms of service. Available at: https://www.gstatic.com/policies/terms/pdf/20200 331/ba461e2f/google_terms_of_service_en_eu.pdf (Accessed: 16 November 2021).

Webpage with no Author

In Text Citation: Former British Prime Minister Theresa May ('Theresa May: Brexit won't be easier if I'm ousted', 2018) claimed that...
Reference List: 'Theresa May: Brexit won't be easier if I'm ousted' (2018). Available at: https://www.bbc.com/news/uk-politics-46250607 (Accessed: 16 November 2021).

Webpage with no Date and no Author

In Text Citation: Compression may be required (New Media Republic, no date)...
Reference List: New Media republic (no date). Compression. Available at: http://newmediarepublic.com/dvideo/compression.html (Accessed: 16 November 2021).
Note: You should generally avoid using webpages with no author and date since it is difficult to establish the reliability and timeliness of the resource.

Secondary Referencing

'Secondary referencing' means referencing a source that was quoted in somebody else's work.
Ideally, You should always try to find the original work but, whenever this is not possible, secondary referencing is acceptable.

Pattern: Author whose idea you are referencing, year of publication, cited in, author of the source you are using, year of publication, page number).

For example, on page 984 of 'Information Technology Identity: A Key Determinant of It Feature and Exploratory', the authors cite a work by Jasperson et al. published in 2005.
In Text Citation: 'As people become more experienced with IT, they develop "habits of use" that allow them to interact with technology efficiently but lead to fewer autonomous attempts at exploration' (Jasperson et al.,2005, cited in, Carter et al.,2020,p.984)
Note: Since you have only read the article by Carter et al, and not the original work by Jasperson, the full reference will only list the source that you have accessed.
Reference List: Carter, M. et al. (2020) 'Information Technology Identity: A Key Determinant of It Feature and Exploratory Usage', MIS Quarterly, 44(3), pp. 983–1021. Available at: https://search.ebscohost.com/login.aspx?direct=true&db=bsh&AN=145446036&site=eds-live (Accessed: 16 November 2021).

Generative AI

Acceptable use of AI

Before utilizing generative AI, ensure that its use is permitted for the specific assignment. Please review the assignment instructions on Moodle or seek guidance from your lecturer.

Use of AI may be listed as following:

Prohibited: The use of generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT, DALL-E, etc.) is not permitted in the assignment in any form. If the assignment is found to have used generative AI tools in an unauthorised way will be subject to college disciplinary procedures as outlined in the QA Manual.

Acceptable and Unacceptable use of AI List: Some use generative AI tools (e.g. ChatGPT, Dall-e, etc.) is permitted in the assignment, but only for the specific activities listed by the lecturer.
Use of generative AI tools in an unauthorised way will be subject to college disciplinary procedures as outlined in the QA Manual.
You are responsible for the information you submit based on an AI query. Your use of AI tools must be properly documented and cited (see citation rules in the next section).

Encouraged and Permitted: You are welcome/expected to use generative AI tools (e.g. ChatGPT, Dall-e, etc.) in the assignment as doing so aligns with the module learning outcomes.
You are responsible for the information you submit based on an AI query. Your use of AI tools must be properly documented and cited (see citation rules in the next section).

Referencing Generative AI Tools

If you utilize ChatGPT or another generative AI to assist in generating ideas or planning your process, it is important to acknowledge the tool's usage, even if you do not incorporate any AI-generated content into the assignment. Please provide a description of the AI tool used, outline your actions, and specify the date of access.

Referencing AI platforms with URL Links

In some instances, the URL link for a session can be generated by the AI. For example, in Chat GPT you can get the URL for your session via the 'share link' function. You can learn how to access the 'share link' function at this link:
https://help.openai.com/en/articles/7925741-chatgpt-shared-links-faq
If the platform provides URLs, then it should be referenced as follows:

Pattern: Author (Year). Title of software program [Format], Available at: URL . (Accessed: Access Date).

In Text Citation: (OpenAI, 2024)
Reference List: OpenAI (2024). ChatGPT 3.5 [Software]. Available at: https://chat.openai.com/share/450c18a2-b49c-4778-a52d-69114963b70a (Accessed: March 5, 2024)

Referencing AI platforms without URL Links

Some platforms don't provide a URL link for each session. If that is the case for the platform that you have used, then you should include a screenshot of the interaction in appendix and reference as follows:

Pattern: Author (Year). Title of software program [Format]. (Accessed: Access Date). See appendix for prompt used and text generated.

In Text Citation: (Google, 2024)
Reference List: Google (2024) *Gemini (Version X)*. Artificial intelligence model. Google DeepMind. (Accessed: 5 March 2024). See appendix for prompt used and text generated.

Referencing Code from GitHub with a listed author/organisation in the Harvard Style

Both individual developers and organisations can be cited as authors.

Pattern: Author(s)/Organisation. (Year). Title of Repository (Version) [Source code]. Platform. URL (Accessed: Access Date).

The following is an example of code with one individual author:

Single Author:

In Text Citation: (Smith, 2023)
Reference List: Smith, J. (2023). *NeuralNet-Predictor* (v1.2) [Source code]. GitHub. **https://github.com/jsmith/neuralnet-predictor** (Accessed: March 5, 2024)
If a code source does not specify an individual author, the organisation should be cited as the author.
The following format should be used when referencing code from organisations:

Organisation as Author:

In Text Citation: (Tensor Flow, 2023)

Reference List: TensorFlow. (2023). *TensorFlow Models* (v2.10) [Source code]. GitHub. https://github.com/tensorflow/models (Accessed: March 5, 2024)

Referencing GitHub Code without an Author in the Harvard Style

If no clear author is listed, the citation should follow this format:

Pattern: GitHub Username. (Year). Title of Repository (Version) [Source code]. Platform. URL (Accessed: Access Date).

In Text Citation: (sachin-source, 2025)

Reference List: sachin-source. (2025). *Top GitHub Repositories Everyone Should Look* [Source code]. GitHub. https://github.com/sachin-source/top-github-repositories-which-everyone-should-look (Accessed: 5 Feb 2025).